About The Author



"Poetry is the opening and closing of a door, leaving those who look through to guess about what was seen during a moment."

- Carl Sandburg

Sandburg was born in Galesburg, Illinois, to parents of Swedish ancestry. Carl August Sandburg (January 6, 1878 – July 22, 1967) was an American poet, writer, and editor. He won three Pulitzer Prizes: two for his poetry and one for his biography of Abraham Lincoln. During his lifetime, Sandburg was widely regarded as "a major figure in contemporary literature", especially for volumes of his collected verse, including **Chicago Poems** (1916), **Cornhuskers** (1918), and **Smoke** and **Steel** (1920). He enjoyed unrivalled appeal as a poet in his day, perhaps because the breadth of his experiences connected him with so many strands of American life, and at his death in 1967, President Lyndon B. Johnson observed that "Carl Sandburg was more than the voice of America, more than the poet of its strength and genius. He was America."

Glossary

humdrum monotony	-	boring routine
soft loam	-	fertile soil
lashes	-	whips
thwarted	-	frustrated
white lies	-	lies told to avoid hurting one's feelings
quest of lucre	-	money gained in a dishonourable way
resenting	-	disliking

1. Fill in the blanks choosing the words from the box given and complete the summary of the poem.

Lines 1-25

The poet Carl Sandburg gives a vivid description of a father's worldly (1)_____ in directing a son who is at the threshold of his (2) _____.

Here the father motivates his son to be like a hard(3)_____and withstand life's (4)_____ and sudden betrayals. (5)_____is like a fertile soil. We can make our life fruitful if we are gentle, and take life as it comes. At times(6)_____ overtakes harshness. The growth of a (7)_____can split a rock. One should have a (8) _____and strong will to achieve. Greed for(9)_____ has left men dead before they really die. Good men also have fallen prey in quest for (10) _____money. Time for (11)_____is not a waste. When you seek knowledge never feel ashamed to be called a(12)_____for not knowing, at the same time learn from your (13) _____and never (14)_____it.

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